

pieces bizarrely entitled *Trois morceaux en forme de poire* (Three Pieces in the Shape of a Pear). He had written these prior to his studies, building on the popularity of his early piano music, but he also set about writing other works for solo piano in a more humorous and less expressive style. In these, he continued the habit he had begun in the 1890s of giving cryptic and witty instructions to the pianist (such as “think right,” “wonder about yourself,” and play “on the tip of the tongue”); and, again, bizarre titles appeared, including *Préludes flasques (pour un chien)* [Flabby preludes (for a dog), 1912] and *Embryons desséchés* (Desiccated embryos, 1913). His aim was probably to poke fun at Debussy, whose impressionistic pieces were embellished with descriptive titles and detailed expression markings.

“ I came into **the world** very **young**, in an **age** that was **very old**. ”

ERIK SATIE

